

Use ChatGPT also use... water? How much water does ChatGPT use?

Posted by u/Alison9876 • 0 points • 8 comments

Apparently every prompt I send to ChatGPT sips real water 🥤 .

[<https://ai.tenorshare.com/chatgpt-tips/how-much-water-does-chatgpt-use.html>]

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Comments

u/Mansenmania • 2 points • 2025-06-19 09:41 UTC

It's just for cooling, it's not like the water is gone or something

u/bobisme • 1 points • 2025-06-19 22:39 UTC

Right, it's not like it gets deleted from existence.

Cool water gets turned hot then eventually becomes cool water again. I would think people would be more concerned about how much heat is being dumped into the environment.

u/Its_Sasha • 1 points • 2025-06-19 04:40 UTC

Notably it's never mentioned that using a single sheet of A4 paper uses 100mL of water, too.

u/Simple_Length5710 • 1 points • 2025-06-19 03:19 UTC

I thought it was just my slow internet... turns out ChatGPT needed a sip of water before replying.

u/AquilaSpot • 5 points • 2025-06-19 02:51 UTC

These numbers are meaningless without being able to compare them to other forms of heavy industry.

Did you know a single cashew needs five gallons of water? Just one nut! I can offer sources when I'm back in a little while, on mobile now.

A pound of beef runs you 1800 gallons of water.

Around three hundred gallons for a pound of oats.

A pound of steel will run you thirty gallons. It's the same ballpark for aluminum.

A kilowatt hour of electricity is, on average, 5-30 gallons. (This is the overwhelming majority of the "ChatGPT uses x gallons per y" - in the power, not the datacenters themselves. Most datacenters use dry coolers and not evaporative cooling iirc). A gallon of gasoline requires 3-6 gallons of water to

produce it.

My point in rattling off numbers is that while "x liters per y questions" sounds like a lot, and while it is, it's silly to take that number alone without considering the obscene amount of water we use in our day to day lives. Even by your numbers, if you eat one less cashew than you would have, you could query ChatGPT over 600 more times (19 litres / 30 ml). Just one singular nut!!

I believe that the benefit of AI/machine learning will soon outweigh the demand for power and water that we are seeing - if these systems do even a tenth of what people hope they can do, I have no doubt the environmental impact will be worth the cost. Nobody doubts the utility of steel and aluminum, but have you ever seen how dirty and polluting a steel mill is?

u/amdcoc • 0 points • 2025-06-22 09:18 UTC

I would rather have water go to actually human consumable goods than something that generates gibberish and puts jobs on risk.

u/FateOfMuffins • 2 points • 2025-06-19 06:01 UTC

Exactly. A lot of numbers are thrown around are meant to push a narrative, preying on the fact that people generally don't know what these numbers mean.

Completely meaningless when you don't know the context. [Did you know the average American consumes 2200 gallons of water a day?](<https://watercalculator.org/footprint/water-footprints-by-country/>). That's 760 billion gallons of water a day (2.9 trillion liters a day), or 277 trillion gallons a year (**1 quadrillion liters**)

Sure puts the 435 million liters in perspective doesn't it?

u/Longjumping-Sweet280 • 1 points • 2025-06-19 02:35 UTC

[this guy knows more than me](<https://www.reddit.com/r/IsItBullshit/s/2pjAWSx8yx>)

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-06-19 02:32 UTC

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If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](<https://discord.gg/r-chatgpt-1050422060352024636>)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

🤖

Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email support@openai.com

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